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Lead Software Developer

Government Internal Audit Agency

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 6th September 2026

Reference number

474375

Salary

£58,429 - £68,132

London £62,411 - £72,617

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

GIAA - Data Analytics

Type of role

Analytical

Architecture and Data

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time

Number of jobs available

2

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Location

We will consider applications from people able to access our offices at the following locations:

Birmingham, Bootle, Bristol, Croydon, Leeds, Manchester, Newcastle, Reading or Swansea

GIAA expects employees to maintain a regular presence at their contractual designated work location and to travel to other GIAA locations or client sites as required for critical meetings and field assignments. Consequently, the contractual location must be selected from those advertised and be within a reasonable daily commuting distance from the employee's home address.

Existing GIAA employees appointed into this new role will be allowed to remain at their current workplace location.

About the job

Job summary

The Government Internal Audit Agency (GIAA) is driven by its unparalleled access across government to build better insights, better outcomes for our clients.

This role offers a strong platform for career progression within the Agency and the wider civil service, providing opportunities to develop leadership, stakeholder engagement and strategic relationship management skills across government.

The Agency's unique access across the public sector exposes you to different risk and control environments, allowing you to gain insights, apply experience, contribute meaningfully, and continue developing professionally.

Job description

The Data Analytics team deliver analytical support to audit and investigation teams, providing high-quality advanced analytics to uncover insight. The team also develop and manage self-serve web applications for internal and external customers, as well as leading on data literacy within the organisation.

This technical role involves developing and maintaining full-stack applications in Django, building agentic AI solutions, and managing Azure hosting infrastructure. Responsibilities include designing software architecture, integrating secure enterprise platforms, creating data models, writing technical documentation, and ensuring system reliability. The role requires expertise in Django, Python, Azure, PostgreSQL, and AI-enabled solutions while adhering to Government Digital Service (GDS) standards. Key deliverables include creating secure, user-centric, high-quality software, supporting team problem-solving, improving development processes, and championing best practices in AI and digital advancements.

Role responsibilities:

- Developing database-driven, web-based applications and maintaining the full stack (frontend and backend)

- Managing and optimising the Azure hosting environment

- Leading the end-to-end technical design, development, and implementation of agentic AI solutions

- Understanding and interpreting customer requirements and designing appropriate solutions

- Conducting testing, fixing bugs and improving software reliability

- Creating data models, workflows, system diagrams, technical documentation and user guides

- Managing stakeholder relationships to promote best practices in AI, data, and digital, helping to grow software development and cloud hosting skills across the team

- Promoting knowledge of GDS best practice and system design and ensuring the team's understanding of the requirements.

Person specification

1. Strong proficiency in developing full-stack Django web applications and knowledge of software architecture design.
2. Experience of maintaining cloud hosting infrastructure (ideally Azure).
3. Problem-solving and analytical thinking to discover root causes of issues and identify solutions.
4. Communicating with stakeholders at all levels, translating customer requirements into technical solutions, managing expectations and discussing high risk and complex topics.
5. Managing workload under time pressure.
6. Curiosity to investigate new and emerging technologies.

To apply for this role, you will need to submit your employment history, personal details and provide a statement of suitability of no more than 750 words, referring to the person specification.

Please note only your statement of suitability will be assessed at the sift stage.

Candidates invited to interview will be required to complete a technical assessment designed to evaluate their role-specific skills focussing on a realistic scenario. At interview you will be assessed on experience, strengths and the following technical skills:

Systems design

Programming and build

IT infrastructure

Qualifications

A degree in a discipline that has a computing element with demonstrated experience in software development, or equivalent extensive work experience as a software developer.

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Systems design

Programming and build

IT infrastructure

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £58,429, Government Internal Audit Agency contributes £16,926 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

Benefits

Competitive salaries and in-year rewards

Flexible working

A [Civil Service Pension](#) with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Discount on big brands

Volunteering days

Season Ticket Loan and Cycle to Work Schemes

Free eyesight tests

Family-friendly HR policies

25 days annual leave increasing by one day per year of service to 30 days after 5 years service

Geographically based Agency

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our

[candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Strengths, Experience and Technical skills.

Recruitment Timeline

Closing date: 06 September 2026

Shortlisting: w/c 07 September 2026

Interviews: w/c 28 September & 05 October 2026

This timeline is indicative and may be subject to change. We will inform you if there is a substantial change to the recruitment timeline.

If your contact details change at any time during the selection process, please ensure you update your Civil Service Jobs profile.

Please note that only applications submitted through Civil Service Jobs will be accepted.

Eligibility Statement

A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role in the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5-year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government. Checks will be performed as part of pre-employment checks in line with this. Please refer to the Candidate FAQ document attached to the advert for more information.

Everyone working with government assets must complete [Baseline Personnel Security Standard \(BPSS\)](#) checks. Additionally, individuals appointed to the Treasury group will be subject to National Security Vetting. The level of security vetting required for this role is [Security Check \(SC\)](#)

To allow for meaningful checks to be carried out, applicants will need to have lived in the UK for at least 3 out of the past 5 years. In exceptional circumstances, for example if you have been working abroad on a government posting, a lack of residency would not be a bar to security

clearance however the Department will need to consider eligibility on a case-by-case basis once the advert closing date has passed.

Please read the [Vetting Charter](#) for information on what to expect during the vetting process and what will be expected from you. Many areas of your life may be explored during your vetting journey, and it is important that every individual, regardless of their background and experiences, should feel comfortable going through this personal process, whilst having confidence that it is fair, proportionate, and inclusive.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Katie Woodhouse

Email : giaarecruitment@giaa.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : giaarecruitment@giaa.gov.uk

Further information

Complaints Procedure: The law requires that selection for appointment to the Civil Service is on merit on the basis of fair and open competition as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles, and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact: GIAARecruitment@giaa.gov.uk in the first instance. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission.

